

Ruffy ruffles the King

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Nigamanth P

nigamanth.p@thehindu.co.in

Finishing a fighter of Bobby 'King' Green's stature is no mean feat.

But to drop him before the end of the first round is an achievement in itself. Brazilian lightweight grappler Mauricio Ruffy did just that and made it look easy at UFC 313.

In the build-up to the fight, the odds were heavily stacked against Ruffy, who was just two fights into his UFC career. Green, on the other hand, had the upper hand, not only because of his experience (31 wins) but also the backing of his home crowd. However, what happened inside the ring underlined the fact that stats can be deceiving.

Ruffy's superior striking ability was evident from the opening bell, but it was his audacious spinning wheel kick (**below**) in the second minute of the first round that sealed the deal.

With Green pressing forward, Ruffy

unleashed a perfectly timed spinning kick, connecting flush with Green's head. The impact was devastating, sending Green crashing to the canvas and prompting an immediate stoppage from the referee.

The 28-year-old's audacious display set social media on fire, with fans and even some pundits claiming it as the knockout of the year.

Ruffy, a Dana White Contender Series graduate, earned his Ultimate Fighting Championship in October 2023 with a knockout win over Russia's Raimond Magomedaliyev.

He then claimed two wins on the bounce but faced his biggest test yet when he was scheduled to take on Green. And he grabbed the opportunity with both hands, letting the world know that he is here to stay.

Shortly after Ruffy's stunning victory, fans were in for yet another shock. Magomed Ankalaev delivered

a decisive performance, dethroning Alex Pereira to claim the light heavyweight championship. The bout saw Ankalaev utilise a strategic plan, involving aggression and precision, that effectively neutralised Pereira's striking prowess.

The first round saw both fighters being tentative with their choice of attacks. Ankalaev was well aware of Pereira's powerful leg kicks and stayed out of his range. Pereira found occasional openings to strike and ended the round on a positive note.

However, Ankalaev's dominance in the next four rounds was evident in the scoreboard as all three judges ruled the bout in his favour. While Pereira's calf kicks were a constant threat, Ankalaev's ability to control the fight through takedowns and strikes proved vital in his win.

Ankalaev joins Islam Makhachev and Khabib Nurmagomedov as the only natives of Dagestan to wear a UFC belt.



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